

Problem #1: Sixteen Japanese Phrases

Solution:

Assignment 1: Match the translations			
<i>Japanese phrase</i>	<i>English translation</i>	<i>Japanese phrase</i>	<i>English translation</i>
<i>niko tamago</i>	two eggs	<i>gohiki neko</i>	five wildcats
<i>gohon kawa</i>	five rivers	<i>rokumai pureto</i>	six plates
<i>hachihon gen</i>	eight strings	<i>nihon hashi</i>	two chopsticks
<i>goko ringo</i>	five apples	<i>kyuhon kawa</i>	nine rivers
<i>kyuhiki inu</i>	nine dogs	<i>kyumai kitte</i>	nine postage stamps
<i>gomai pureto</i>	five plates	<i>hachihiki ari</i>	eight ants
<i>nihiki neko</i>	two wildcats	<i>kyuko tama</i>	nine balls
<i>rokumai enberopu</i>	six envelopes	<i>rokuko tama</i>	six balls
Assignment 2: Given your current knowledge and that <i>tiger</i> translates to <i>tora</i> in Japanese, which of the following would be valid and why?			
nihiki tora			
Assignment 3: Which of the following are correct/valid Japanese phrases? Provide the English translations for the correct ones. If invalid, write INVALID.			
Japanese Phrase	English translation	Japanese Phrase	English translation
<i>hachimai hashi</i>	INVALID	<i>niko ringo</i>	two apples
<i>rokuhon yajirushi</i>	six arrows	<i>hachiko hashi</i>	INVALID
<i>gohiki zo</i>	INVALID	<i>goto neko</i>	INVALID

- The order of the words is <Number word> <Noun>
- The number word is a compound which breaks up into <Number> + <Counter> where the counter marks agreement with the class of the noun
- There are 5 counter words:
 - *ko* for small and/or round things
 - *mai* for flat things
 - *hon* for long and/or thin things
 - *hiki* for animals (based on Assignment 1)
 - Refined knowledge : (based on following Assignments)
 - *hiki* for small animals
 - *to* for large animals